

BUILD THE HOUSE OF GOD

A Sermon for the Building Fund Drive

FPFK Kericho Town Church
Rev. Gideon Yegon, Senior Pastor
Free Pentecostal Fellowship in Kenya

Haggai 1:7-8 (NIV)

"This is what the Lord Almighty says: 'Give careful thought to your ways. Go up into the mountains and bring down timber and build my house, so that I may take pleasure in it and be honoured,' says the Lord."

SERMON DETAILS

Theme: Building the House of God — Our Sacred Responsibility

Key Text: Haggai 1:1-15

Support Texts: 1 Chronicles 29:1-20; Nehemiah 2:17-18; Malachi 3:10; Luke 21:1-4; 2 Corinthians 9:6-8

Aim: To stir the congregation to joyful, sacrificial giving toward the church building project, grounded in the Word of God.

INTRODUCTION

 **Preacher's Note:** Open with a brief, relatable story — perhaps the image of a family living in a well-furnished home while God's house stands unfinished. Allow the congregation a moment of reflection before reading the text.

Brothers and sisters, there is a question that echoes across the ages, first spoken by the prophet Haggai to the returned exiles of Israel — and it is a question the Holy Spirit speaks to us today:

Haggai 1:4 (NIV)

"Is it a time for you yourselves to be living in your panelled houses, while this house remains a ruin?"

The people of God had returned from Babylon with joy, with purpose, with divine permission. They had laid the foundation of the Temple. But then — they stopped. Life got busy. Their own projects felt more urgent. The house of God could wait.

Sound familiar? There are seasons in the life of every church when the vision gets deferred. When the needs are real but the momentum stalls. When people say, 'The time has not yet come.' But today I want to declare to you: The time has come. It is our moment to build.

 **Preacher's Note:** *Pause here. Make eye contact with the congregation. Let the weight of the moment settle before moving into the body of the sermon.*

PART ONE: GOD CALLS US TO CONSIDER OUR WAYS

Haggai 1:5-7 — 'Give careful thought to your ways'

The Lord does not rebuke the Israelites for being poor. He rebukes them for misplaced priorities. They planted much but harvested little. They ate but were not satisfied. They earned wages but the money disappeared like a hole in a pocket (v.6). Why? Because the house of God was neglected.

God's economy is clear: when we honour His house, He honours our house. When we put His kingdom first, He ensures that 'all these things shall be added' to us (Matthew 6:33). But when we reverse the order — building our comfort while His work stands unfinished — we experience a mysterious shortfall, a spiritual drought that no amount of human striving can fix.

Haggai 1:9 (NIV)

"You expected much, but see, it turned out to be little. What you brought home, I blew away. Why?" declares the Lord Almighty. "Because of my house, which remains a ruin, while each of you is busy with your own house."

Church, I want us to give careful thought today. Not thought born of guilt, but thought born of vision. This building is not about walls and a roof. It is about:

- A sanctuary where the broken will find healing
- A hall where young people will encounter God and not the street
- A training ground where the Diploma students of this Pastoral Care programme will be equipped to serve the nation
- A witness to the community of Kericho that the Church of the Living God is here, and she is strong

 **Preacher's Note:** *Optional: Share a brief testimony or statistic about the current capacity constraints of the church — overcrowding, lack of facilities, deferred programmes. Make it concrete and local.*

PART TWO: GOD INVITES US TO BE PART OF SOMETHING ETERNAL

1 Chronicles 29:1-20 — David's Generous Example

One of the most powerful fundraising passages in Scripture is found not in a church epistle but in the Old Testament — in the account of King David gathering resources for the Temple he would never personally build.

David gave from his personal treasury — gold, silver, bronze, iron, wood — in staggering quantities. He did not stop there. He challenged the leaders and people of Israel to give willingly. And what happened?

1 Chronicles 29:9 (NIV)

"The people rejoiced at the willing response of their leaders, for they had given freely and wholeheartedly to the Lord. David the king also rejoiced greatly."

Notice: they gave wholeheartedly. Not under compulsion. Not grudgingly. They gave because they had caught the vision. They understood that they were participating in something that would outlast their own lifetimes.

I want to ask you today: what will you leave behind? What will your grandchildren point to and say, 'My grandfather was part of building that'? Your name may not be engraved on a wall. But God sees every gift. He keeps every record. He forgets nothing given in His name.



Preacher's Note: At this point you may invite ushers to come forward, or acknowledge the giving envelopes/pledges in the bulletin. Keep the energy reverent but joyful — this is a celebration, not a collection.

PART THREE: GOD HONOURS THE GIVER — THE PRINCIPLE OF SOWING AND REAPING

2 Corinthians 9:6-8 & Malachi 3:10 — You Cannot Outgive God

Some may wonder: 'Can I afford to give?' The real question is: can you afford not to give? For the Word of God is plain:

2 Corinthians 9:6-7 (NIV)

"Remember this: whoever sows sparingly will also reap sparingly, and whoever sows generously will also reap generously. Each of you should give what you have decided in your heart to give, not reluctantly or under compulsion, for God loves a cheerful giver."

God does not need our money. He owns the cattle on a thousand hills (Psalm 50:10). What He desires is our hearts. And giving is one of the most powerful ways we demonstrate where our hearts truly lie.

The widow whom Jesus honoured in Luke 21 did not give the largest gift by amount — but she gave the largest gift by proportion. She gave all she had. And Jesus, the One who spoke worlds into existence with a word, stopped to commend her to His disciples for all eternity.

Malachi 3:10 (NIV)

"Bring the whole tithe into the storehouse, that there may be food in my house. Test me in this," says the Lord Almighty, "and see if I will not throw open the floodgates of heaven and pour out so much blessing that there will not be room enough to store it."

God says: test Me. This is the only place in Scripture where God invites us to put Him to the test. Give to the building of His house — give generously, give cheerfully, give in faith — and watch what God does in your life, your family, and your business.

 **Preacher's Note:** *Illustration opportunity: Share a testimony (from the congregation or elsewhere) of someone who gave sacrificially to God's work and experienced divine provision. Keep it verifiable and grounded.*

PART FOUR: 'LET US RISE AND BUILD'

Nehemiah 2:17-18 — The Power of Corporate Vision

When Nehemiah arrived in Jerusalem and saw the broken walls, he did not resign himself to despair. He gathered the people and cast a vision. He told them what God had placed on his heart. He told them what God had already done. And the people responded:

Nehemiah 2:18 (NIV)

"They replied, 'Let us start rebuilding.' So they began this good work."

I am standing before you today as your pastor, your servant, to declare: Let us start rebuilding. Let us finish what God started here. Every brick, every beam, every shilling given in faith is an act of worship. Every sacrifice made for the Lord's house is a prayer that echoes into eternity.

Nehemiah 4:6 tells us that the wall was completed at half its height 'because the people worked with all their heart.' That is my prayer for FPFK Kericho Town today — that we are the people who worked with all their heart.

 **Preacher's Note:** *This is a powerful moment to pause, look at your people, and speak directly from the heart. Drop the manuscript if you need to. Let the Spirit lead. Then bring the sermon home with the conclusion below.*

CONCLUSION: WHAT WILL YOU DO TODAY?

The prophet Haggai records something remarkable. After his first message, we read in Haggai 1:14:

Haggai 1:14 (NIV)

"So the Lord stirred up the spirit of Zerubbabel son of Shealtiel, governor of Judah, and the spirit of Joshua son of Jozadak, the high priest, and the spirit of the whole remnant of the people. They came and began to work on the house of the Lord Almighty, their God."

God stirred their spirits. He is stirring your spirit today. That nudge you feel — that awareness that you should do something — that is not the preacher. That is the Holy Spirit.

I want to invite you to respond in three ways:

1. PRAY — Commit this project to God. Pray for wisdom, for resources, for supernatural provision.
2. PLEDGE — Give what God has laid on your heart today. No amount is too small. No gift goes unseen by God.
3. PARTNER — Spread the word. Invite others to share in this vision. A house of God built by a whole community stands as a witness for generations.

*The Lord our God be with us as He was with our fathers.
May He never leave us nor forsake us — and may this house be built to His glory.*

 **Preacher's Note:** Close in prayer, then transition to the offering/pledge moment. If there is a worship team, lead into a song of dedication — something like 'I Surrender All' or 'We Are Standing on Holy Ground.'

SUGGESTED CLOSING PRAYER

Heavenly Father, we come before You as Your people — imperfect, yet called; finite, yet filled with Your Spirit. Today we commit to build Your house. We commit our resources, our time, our faith. Stir our spirits as You stirred those of Zerubbabel and Joshua. Let no opposition deter us, no shortage discourage us, and no delay defeat us. For You are the God who finishes what He starts, and You have started something great here in Kericho. We declare it in the name of Jesus — the house shall be built, and in it Your name shall be glorified. Amen.

PREACHER'S NOTES / ILLUSTRATIONS SPACE

Personal illustrations / testimonies:
